‘dictatorship’ and ‘Hitlerism’.[56] On the specific charge of being a communal party, he accused the Congress, in turn, of deliberately misleading the Muslims. He declared at an election rally in Champaran in December 1951 that the safety of the minority lay ‘not in backing the Congress’ but in ‘the goodwill of the majority’. Far from the Jan Sangh being a party of ‘Seths’, as Nehru had sneered, Mookerji countered that most capitalists and landed magnates were with the Congress.[57] Repeated references to the Jan Sangh as being reactionary and communal, in fact, were an attempt to ‘sidetrack grave issues of a national character and hide the failures and weaknesses of the Nehru government’.[58]

Figure 9.1: Nehru Framed Independent India’s First Election as a Contest between Communal and Secular Forces; Jan Sangh Joined Other Hindu Nationalist Parties against Congress